



Nikon S520



Nikon S52



Nikon S210



Nikon S550

class. The S52 also has a very impressive screen.

The COOLPIX S210 is a compact camera with the proportions as cell phone. It too is a little noisy like the S520. This is another solidly build camera much like the S52. In the zoomed

shots, quality is fine. Colours too are fine except a few colours which seem paler than expected. There is little grain, but the exposure isn't accurate either.

The Nikon COOLPIX S550 – the last of the Nikon's in the group has the largest optical zoom of 5x. There was a lot of noise in all of the test images. The S550 has a feature that keeps track of faces and has a database. That's something not seen very often in cameras. The quality of the screen in general is average and the camera itself looks like a mix of the L series and S series from Nikon.

Fujifilm FinePix S5700

The Fujifilm FinePix S5700 is something like an ultra zoom camera, but it comes with 10x optical zoom. The camera has a deep handgrip for one-handed operation. It is far lighter than the ultra zoom or pseudo-SLR we got in this test—the Olympus SP-570 UZ. The optical lens has a protective barrel around it, so the lens never protrudes out of the camera. The dials on the camera are made of plastic. Although the body itself feels light-weight, it uses 4 batteries which make it heavier.

The screen is rather dull to look at. Like in some SLR's, some of the functions have to be accessed by button combinations. This is something a new user won't necessarily discover easily.

Images from all the tests turn out grainy. Video recording works nice even though it records at 640 x 480. Zooming works well while recording videos. The flash is extremely harsh.

The S5700 is approaching the end of its life, and is currently one of the cheapest cameras with a 10x optical zoom to buy at a price of Rs 12,999. A replacement is already on sale in some countries—the S5800.



Fujifilm FinePix S5700

Fujifilm FinePix Z100fd

The FinePix Z100fd from Fujifilm is a compact little camera with some serious style. The camera, for example, turns on by sliding the protection panel in front of the lens. It has a brushed metal finish to it and the illuminated logo in the front adds to its elegance. It is compact and built well without compromising on style. The 5x optical zoom is impressive for a camera this compact and that makes it more than just another device to show-off.

The clarity of the shots taken outdoors is average and lags behind the other cameras in its category. There is a little grain in the photos, but the colours seem a little too prominent and emphasised. There isn't a whole lot of detail in the shots too. The zoom shots are pretty decent. Although the quality isn't a lot better, there isn't the same amount of distortion and smudginess seen in zoom shots in most other cameras. The ruler in our scene was pretty crisp and the text was well defined in the zoom shot.

There are nice little features in it as well. One of the more useful ones is where you can have the camera click two photos—with and without flash. That way you won't ruin a photo if you have a low light scene. The image stabilisation feature works well. Buttons are small, but are designed well, and have a chrome-like feel and look to them.

The camera allows wireless image transfers, and there is an infrared port on the side for that purpose. Images can be sent to printers and even other cameras



Fujifilm FinePix Z100fd

through infrared. The trimming can be done straight from the camera itself without to having to transfer images to a PC and then edit it there.

Kodak Easyshare M1063

The Kodak Easyshare M1063 sports a compact design. The camera comes with a 3x optical zoom and a 10.3 MP MegaPixel. The quality of the design and feel isn't up to the mark and this camera fails to impress. The user



Kodak Easyshare M1063

interface looks good and is simple to use. Videos can be recorded at a maximum of 15 fps which makes it not very practical. Overall, it's an OK camera with a low price.

Wallets Unleashed! Cameras Over Rs 16,001

Samsung NV24HD

The Samsung is another unique camera that we got. Much can't be said about its performance, but what it does have

is features. The biggest impressive features are the touch sensitive buttons lining the sides of the screen. They make operating the menus and all the settings extremely simple.

The NV24HD not only supports HDMI but also HD video recording. It records videos at resolutions of 1280 x 720 at 30fps. Videos are recorded using H.264 so a good amount of video can be stored as compared to some of the uncompressed video formats used in other cameras. We shot a 1280 x 720 resolution video tat was 25 seconds long, and it took up only 20 MB of space. The HDMI support means images can be viewed on large screens without a lot of quality loss.

As usual, there is one dial for selecting the modes and there's another one that changes the coloration for the images. We fired test shots with all settings turned to Auto. It was clear that the quality was above average. In a category where all the cameras

were so closely matched, the performance and a little bit of design was to blame for its lowered overall score. We awarded it one of the best scores for the video quality. With its great compression, it also makes a good video recorder, and not just a digital camera.

For a camera with so many features, the design could be a lot better. The flash for example is just a simple cube that pops out from the top of the camera. The build however is solid and great. Sharp edges could leave scratches to its finish though.



Samsung NV24HD

A camera such as this is ideal for someone who wants to shoot, but doesn't know how to get all the settings. The touch buttons definitely help in making things accessible.

Olympus Stylus 1030 SW

The Olympus Stylus 1030 SW has to be the toughest camera of the lot. Olympus claims the camera is all of the following—shockproof, crushproof, waterproof and even freeze-proof! It doesn't look like they're bluffing. The camera sports huge screws along its solid metal body while still maintaining its look and aesthetics. It does look a bit different from other cameras and also weighs a lot for its fairly compact size.

As compared to the other Olympus cameras, it is just next to the SP-570 UZ ultra zoom camera but is also cheaper by Rs 2,000. The performance as compared to the rest in its category is a little lacking, but not by a lot. There was a tad bit of colouration in the test shots.

The camera isn't all about its sturdiness. It also comes with the features found on the latest Olympus cameras. With shooting underwater in mind, there's a small LED light that can be activated while using the macro function. Typically, a camera's flash is too harsh and using it in such close proximity to an object ends up in terrible images. Another unheard of feature is the manometer on the camera to measure height and depth of the camera.